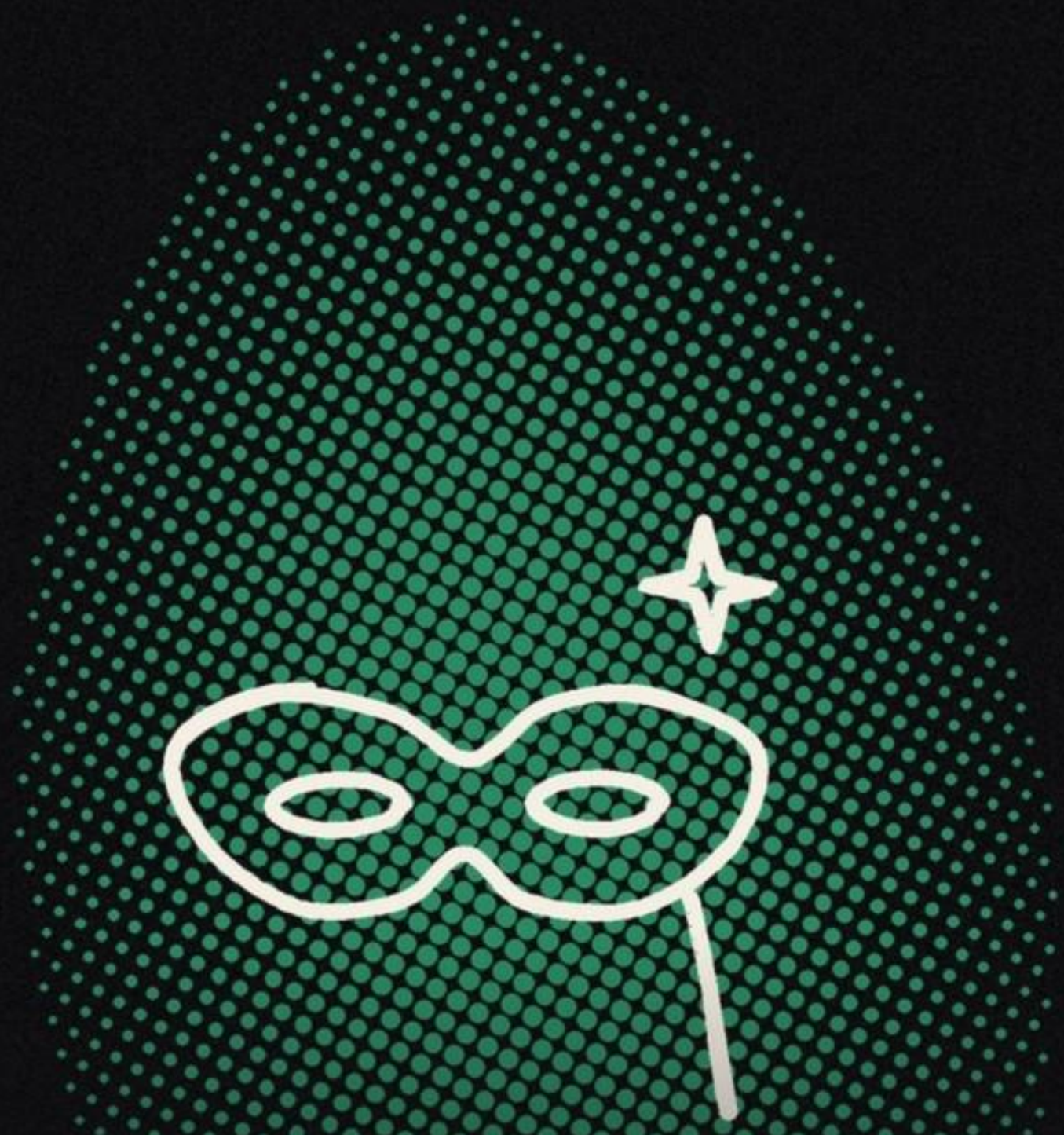
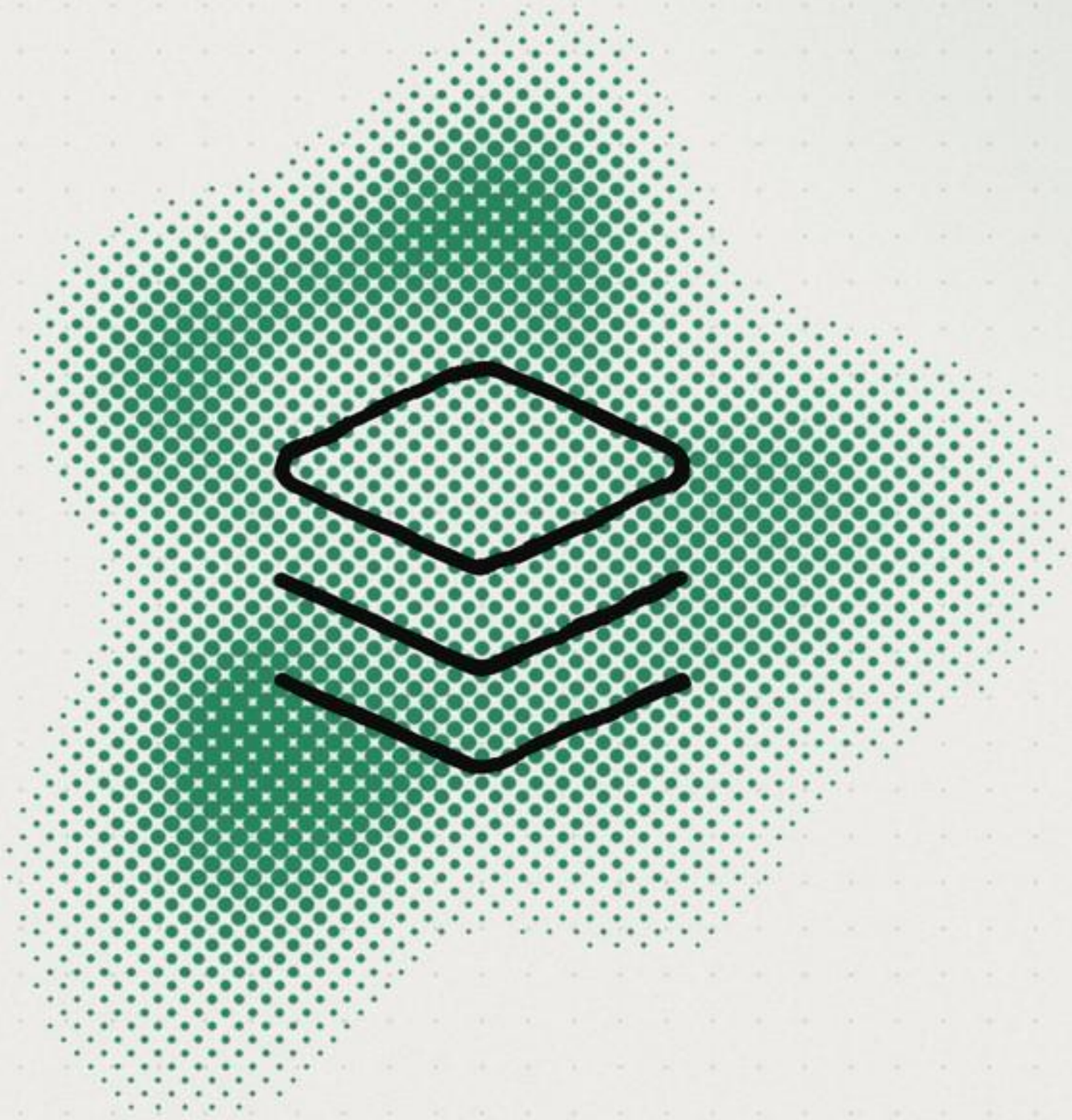


AUG 11, 2026

Spotify's AI badge is about the face on your profile

Spotify announced the AI Persona badge on August 11, 2026. Here's what triggers it and what it costs a release.

By Benjamin Means · swipe →

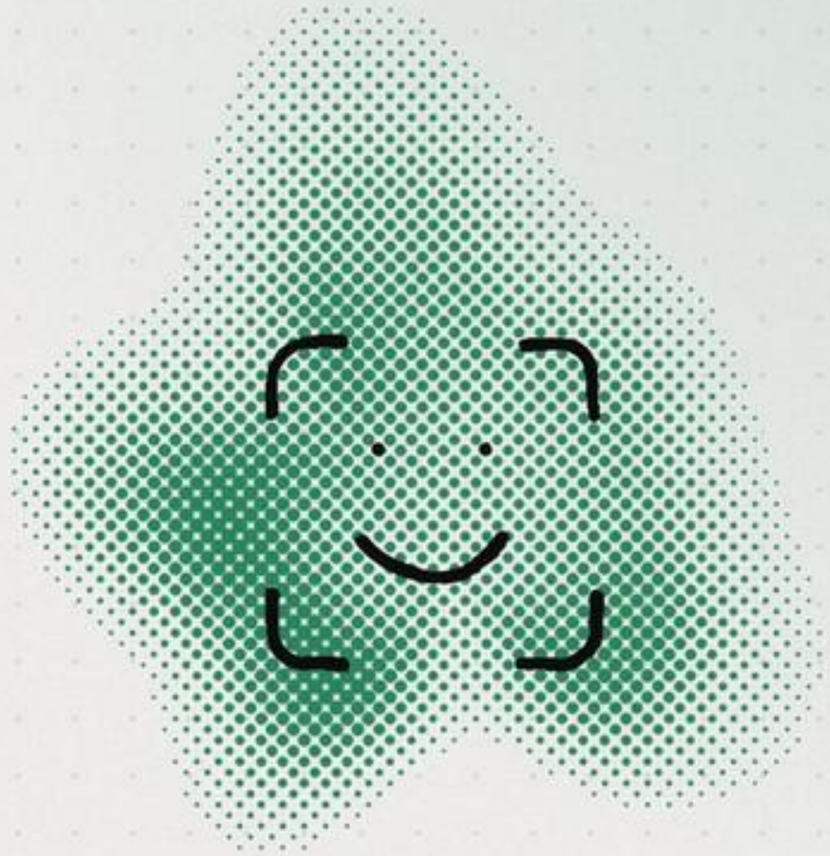


THREE SYSTEMS

Three things get called the AI badge.

The AI Persona badge, AI credits and the music spam filter. Only the Persona badge is a public label that keeps an artist out of recommendations.

Spotify newsroom, Sept 2025 and Aug 2026



THE TRIGGER

What triggers the badge

Spotify’s review looks at the artist’s name and imagery, album artwork included.

A photorealistic AI-generated person as the artist	TRIGGERS IT
AI tools on the music, a real person on the profile	DOESN’T
A stage name or a character that isn’t photoreal	DOESN’T

Spotify artist help page, read Oct 15, 2026

THE COST

What the badge costs a release

The exception Spotify gives is listeners who follow an AI Persona.

Editorial and algorithmic recommendations	OFF BY DEFAULT
Discovery Mode	NOT ELIGIBLE
Verified by Spotify	NOT ELIGIBLE
Marquee and Showcase	NOT ELIGIBLE

Spotify, Aug 11, 2026 · help pages read Oct 15, 2026

VERIFIED

Verification has a wider bar

99%+

OF THE ARTISTS LISTENERS ACTIVELY SEARCH ARE VERIFIED

A badged AI Persona	NOT ELIGIBLE
A profile that appears primarily AI-generated	NOT ELIGIBLE
AI tools, presented authentically	STILL ELIGIBLE

Spotify, Aug 2026 · verification page read Oct 15, 2026

APPEALS

You can’t switch it off yourself

Spotify adds, “We make all final decisions.”

Self-disclosed AI Persona	CAN’T TURN OFF
Likely AI Persona, from Spotify’s review	STAYS IF YOU DON’T ACT
How appeals are judged	NOT PUBLISHED
A new name, image or bio	CAN TRIGGER REVIEW

Spotify artist help page, read Oct 15, 2026

PAID ADS

What it means for paid ads

1 **Check the cover and profile images**

Spotify reviews the name, profile image, header and artwork.

2 **Watch the cover in your ads**

Spotify doesn’t review them, but they show the same face.

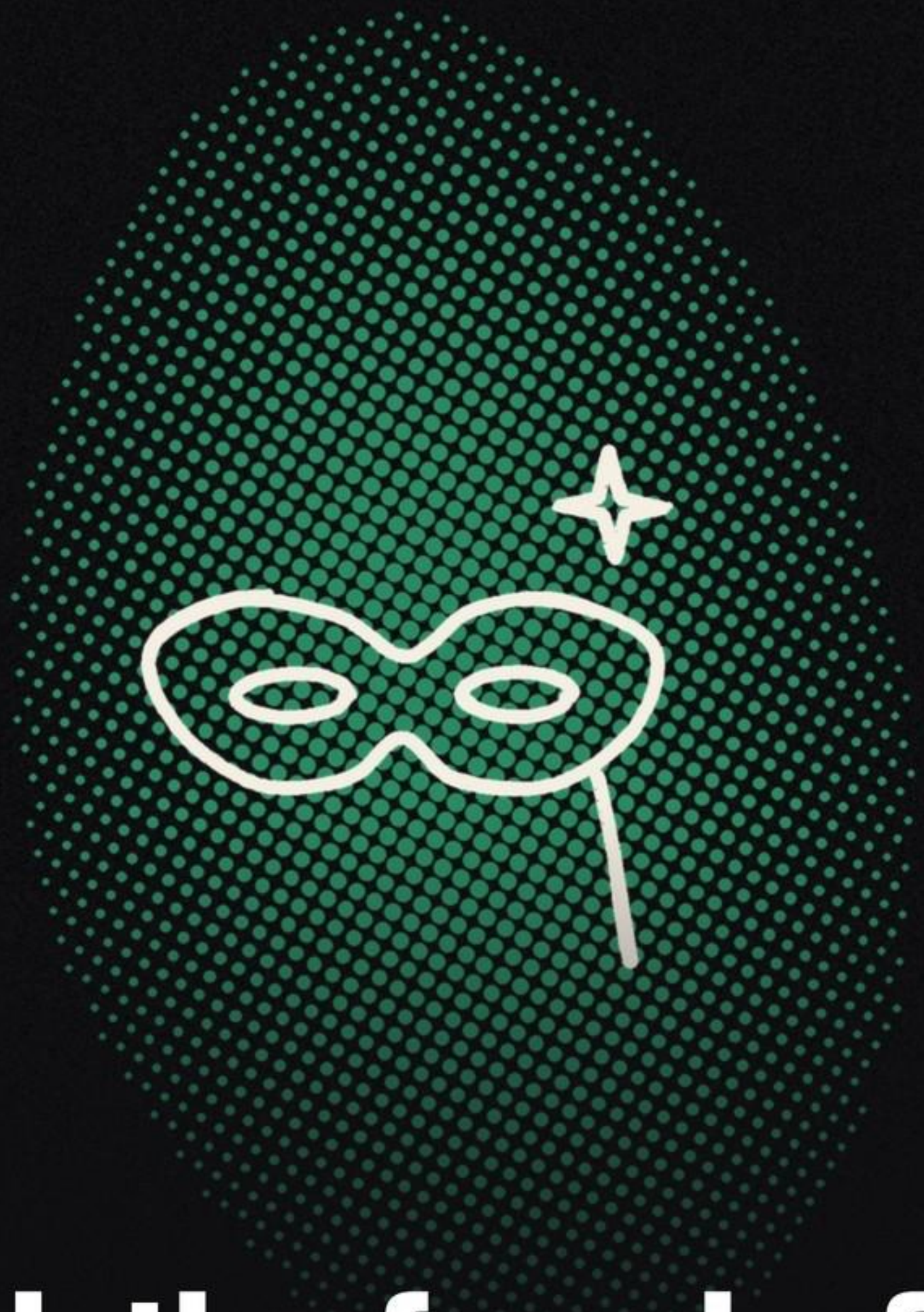
3 **Plan without Discovery Mode or Marquee**

If that face is the act’s public identity, expect the badge.

4 **Run ads for follows**

Following is the one signal Spotify has named.

Our read. Spotify hasn’t said how much a follow counts.



OUR READ

Check the face before release day.

Spotify hasn’t published how appeals are judged. Plan as if the badge is still there on release day.

Full post at meansmgmt.com